

with small tips and tricks at no extra cost, you earn goodwill. People will soon begin seeing you as an expert in the field. Once that status has been achieved, it won't be long before people come knocking at your door for more. And this is when you begin to charge!

Here's an example of how it could work. A nutritionist is added to a Facebook group that caters mainly to new mums trying to get back into shape postpartum. The posts made by the trainer to the group include everything from motivational images, tips and tricks on how to eat clean, to 'dos and don'ts' in the first few months after delivery. Soon mums are running to the trainer for advice on what to eat. This is a good time to introduce the 'customised meal plans' at a cost. Chances of mums jumping on the bandwagon are pretty high because they already trust the trainer, and he/she is an everyday name for them.

Be open to feedback

Constructive criticism could be your best friend. So could listening to new ideas. While you already have your own set of ideas for new projects, you will be surprised at how much 'listening to the customer' helps. For instance, try posting on your social media about your thoughts for the next blog post. Open it up to suggestions and you might receive a zillion ideas for the said blog post and 10 more after it.

When the perspective of advertising shifts from 'self promotion' to 'understanding what the customer wants', chances are your services will sell better. Customers trust a service provider who listens to their needs and discusses their wants. Be open to criticism. Give assurance that you will work on the problem and better your product. Be open to ideas. Your clients might end up giving you your 'next best idea' on a platter.

While advertising yourself as a freelancer may sound hard, it doesn't need to be complicated. Work on building your tribe. The more loyal customers you have, the larger your chances of recurrent contracts. And the points mentioned earlier here should help you tackle the sea of potential clients and customers out there. While you do not have to blatantly 'sell yourself', do not refrain from talking about your work in social media or offline networking parties. No one ever became successful from standing on the sidelines and watching! Get out there. Sell your work a little and then let your work do all the talking. 